Lesson 0.2: The AI Fluency 4D framework

Claude Certified Associate – Foundations (CCAO-F) · Section 0: Start Here · Lesson 2 · 11:24

Description

Meet the four habits this whole course is built on: Anthropic's AI Fluency framework and its four Ds, Delegation, Description, Discernment and Diligence. You learn the twelve skills inside them, the two loops that connect them, and where each D lands on the CCAO-F exam, with Anthropic's official anchors kept apart from this course's own mapping. Every definition is shown in Anthropic's own courses. Then you watch all four Ds turn real planning notes into a course-announcement email in Claude Desktop, with every fact checked against the notes, one slip caught and fixed, and the result owned before it is shared.

Learning outcomes

By the end of this lesson you can:

1. Name the four Ds and say what each one means.
2. Explain the two loops that connect them, and where each D lands on the exam.
3. Use all four on a real task in Claude: hand over, describe, check, and own the result.

Chapters

Time	Chapter
00:00	Preview and outcomes
00:35	Why it matters
01:22	The four Ds
03:39	Straight from the source
05:13	Hands-on: all four Ds on one real email
09:45	Exam angle
10:45	Recap and quick check

Key terms

- **AI Fluency:** working with AI in ways that are effective, efficient, ethical and safe.
- **Delegation:** deciding whether, when and how to use AI, and splitting the work between you and it. Its three skills are Problem Awareness (knowing your goal before AI gets involved), Platform Awareness (knowing what different AI tools can and can't do) and Task Delegation (giving each side the work it does best).
- **Description:** telling AI what you need. Product Description is what you want back (output, format, audience, style). Process Description is how the AI should go about it.

Performance Description is how it should behave with you, for example brief or detailed, supportive or challenging.

- **Discernment:** judging what AI gives back. Product Discernment asks whether the output is accurate and relevant. Process Discernment asks whether the reasoning held up. Performance Discernment asks whether the way the AI works with you is actually helping.
- **Diligence:** taking responsibility for what you do with AI. Creation Diligence is choosing your tools and methods with care. Transparency Diligence is being honest about AI's role with everyone who needs to know. Deployment Diligence is verifying and vouching for what you share.
- **Description–Discernment loop (inner loop):** describe, judge the result, refine, repeat. This is the moment-to-moment loop.
- **Delegation–Diligence loop (outer loop):** what you hand over raises questions of responsibility, and the answers reshape what you hand over. The loop runs both ways. The outer loop sets the container that the inner loop fills.
- Also mentioned in the framework: three ways of working with AI, Automation, Augmentation and Agency. The four Ds apply to all three.

The four Ds and the exam

D	Exam domain	Who says so
Description	Domain 1, Prompting and Task Execution (14%)	**Anthropic.** The official prep course for Domain 1 calls Description "the backbone of this module".
Delegation	Domain 4, Workflow Integration and Solution Design (16%)	**Anthropic.** The official prep course for Domain 4 names Delegation its "anchoring competency".
Discernment	Domain 2, Output Evaluation and Validation (21%, the biggest domain)	**This course's mapping.** The public prep-course text names no competency here.
Diligence	Domain 6, Governance, Risk, and Responsible Use (15%)	**This course's mapping.** The public prep-course text names no competency here. The exam guide's Sample 1 rationale calls verification "the diligence step required".

The exam's task statements never use the words Delegation, Description or Discernment, so don't expect to be asked to name the Ds. Expect to be asked to act like someone who practises them.

What the AI Fluency Index found

Anthropic's AI Fluency Index (first published February 23, 2026) studied 9,830 multi-turn Claude.ai conversations from one week in January 2026. When Claude produced finished-

looking work (12.3% of the sample), people gave clearer directions about their goal (+14.7 points) and format (+14.5 points), but were less likely to flag missing context (−5.2), check facts (−3.7) or question Claude's reasoning (−3.1), at least in the chat. Better directions, weaker checking.

Quick check

Before you move on, take this lesson's quick check. It's a few short questions and takes a couple of minutes. The exam-style question in this lesson, the module quizzes and the practice exams are all original, written for this course against the official blueprint. They are never copies of the real exam.

Sources (all checked 2026-10-03)

- **Rick Dakan, Joseph Feller and Anthropic, *The AI Fluency Framework*** (one page), CC BY-NC-SA 4.0: https://www-cdn.anthropic.com/b383cf6baddbfc72fdf8b0ed533a518e2872d531.pdf. The four Ds, AI Fluency, and the three modes.
- **Rick Dakan, Joseph Feller and Anthropic, *AI Fluency: Key Terminology Cheat Sheet***, CC BY-NC-SA 4.0: https://www-cdn.anthropic.com/4396730ed190e691a3712cf2fd6bfe35509deca2.pdf. Definitions of the four Ds and all twelve skills.
- **Claude Academy, *AI Fluency: Framework and foundations*:** https://academy.claude.com/courses/ai-fluency-framework-foundations. 14 lessons, readable without an account. Its learning outcomes name every skill and "the Description-Discernment loop". The course page credits Dakan (Ringling College of Art and Design) and Feller (University College Cork), who developed the framework in 2023–2024.
    - Lesson *The 4D Framework*: https://academy.claude.com/courses/ai-fluency-framework-foundations/the-4d-framework
    - Lesson *A closer look at Discernment*: https://academy.claude.com/courses/ai-fluency-framework-foundations/a-closer-look-at-discernment ("works hand-in-hand with Description in a continuous feedback loop")
- **Claude Academy, *Teaching AI Fluency*** (a course for educators):
    - *The Delegation-Diligence loop*: https://academy.claude.com/courses/teaching-ai-fluency/the-delegation-diligence-loop ("the loop runs both ways")
    - *The Description-Discernment loop*: https://academy.claude.com/courses/teaching-ai-fluency/the-description-discernment-loop (the two loops as nested systems)
- **Anthropic Education Report, *The AI Fluency Index*:** https://academy.claude.com/tutorials/the-ai-fluency-index. Originally published February 23, 2026.
- **Anthropic, official CCAO-F prep path.** Its prerequisites recommend Claude 101, AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations, and AI Capabilities and Limitations before you start.
    - Prep course 2 of 8, *Prompting & Task Execution* (exam Domain 1): "About this course", paragraph 2.

    - Prep course 4 of 8, *Workflow Integration & Solution Design* (exam Domain 4): "About this course", paragraph 2.
- **Anthropic, *Claude Certified Associate – Foundations Exam Guide*.** Version 1.0, effective July 2026. §6 domains and weights; §8 Sample 1 rationale.

The Academy's video lessons were not played or quoted; only their page text is shown. Product names and layouts can change. The Claude Desktop shown here still had the Chat | Cowork toggle on 2026-10-03.